

Anaphoric Definiteness in Korean Sign Language: The role of NP_{LOC} and NP-IX_{THIS}

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1. Introduction

Definiteness is a central concept in human language. In spoken languages, it is typically marked by morphosyntactic elements such as weak or strong definite articles (e.g., German) (Schwarz 2009) or bare nouns or demonstrative-NPs (e.g., Mandarin Chinese, Shan, Korean) (Simpson & Wu 2022, Moroney 2021, Dayal & Jiang 2023, Kang 2021, Kim 2023a,b) and analyzed in terms of identifiability, uniqueness, and familiarity (Lyons 1999, Russell 1905, Christophersen 1939).

In recent years, researchers studying sign languages have explored how spatial reference and pointing, in particular deictic indexing, contribute to anaphoric definiteness marking (e.g., Klima & Bellugi 1979, Lillo-Martin & Klima 1990, Koulidobrova & Lillo-Martin 2016).

Much like other sign languages (Lillo-Martin 1986, Irani 2016, Ahn et al. 2019, Davidson 2022), Korean Sign Language (KSL) employs spatial loci and pointing gestures. However, exactly how they help encode anaphoric definiteness has not been systematically studied. This paper aims to fill this gap by looking at how KSL marks anaphoric definites, focusing on NP_{LOC} and NP-IX_{THIS}.

We show that in KSL what we call NP_{LOC} is a strong definite comparable to demonstrative anaphoric NPs in spoken Korean, and that what we call NP-IX_{THIS} encodes anaphoric noteworthiness, paralleling emphatic demonstratives like *this very N* in spoken English. We propose a formal semantic analysis of NP_{LOC} and NP-IX_{THIS}, adopting Kim's (2023b) locative-relation based framework, in which indexing and locus are separated from each other. Our analysis will be shown to have implications for anaphoric definiteness marking in American Sign Language (ASL) as well as other (bare noun) languages.

This paper is organized as follows: Section 2 provides theoretical background on anaphoric definiteness marking in sign languages by using ASL as an example case since it is arguably the most well-studied sign language at the time of writing. Section 3 introduces referential expressions in KSL. Section 4 presents a formal semantic analysis of NP_{LOC} and NP-IX_{THIS}. Section 5 concludes the paper with implications for future research.

2. Theoretical Background on Anaphoric Definiteness Marking in Sign Languages

In ASL, anaphoric definiteness is encoded via several strategies. These include (a) a null argument recoverable from context; (b) repetition of a bare noun; (c) use of a neutral pointing sign IX_{NEUT} without spatial anchoring; and (d) use of a spatially anchored pointing sign IX-a, which associates locus *a*, some specific signing space, to a referent.¹ Each of these strategies are exemplified in (1a), (1b), (1c), and (1d), respectively, which are taken from Ahn et al. 2019: (1)–(2).

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¹ The choice among these forms is not arbitrary: null arguments are the default and most frequent strategy when a single salient referent is available; bare NPs are used when additional lexical specification is needed; IX_{NEUT} is licensed when animacy features suffice to disambiguate the referent; and IX-a is typically reserved for contexts involving competing referents (Ahn et al. 2019).

- (1) BOY ENTER CLASSROOM.
 a. HAPPY. [null argument]
 b. BOY HAPPY. [bare NPs]
 c. IX HAPPY. [IX_{NEUT}]
 d. IX-a HAPPY. [IX-a]
 ‘A boy_i entered a classroom. He_i was happy.’

Of these four expressions, IX-a is particularly worth noting since it enables referent tracking through spatial anchoring. The role of IX-a is further exemplified in (2), where the proper name *Gia* is introduced and then referred back to using a pointing sign to the same locus *a* (Davidson 2022: (86)).

- (2) fs(Gia) IX-a Happy. IX-a LIKE TEA
 ‘Gia_i is happy. She_i (Gia) likes tea.’

Loci in ASL can both track referents and resolve potential ambiguity. In (3), distinct loci are assigned to two individuals, allowing reference to *Gia* without lexical repetition (Davidson 2022: (90)). Similarly, in (4), using pointing plus locus disambiguates the antecedent ‘book’ from the competing referent ‘magazine’ (Irani 2016).

- (3) IX-a fs(Gia) a-HELP-b IX-b fs(Lex). IX-a LIKE ARTIST
 ‘Gia_i helps Lex_j. She_i (Gia) is a wonderful artist.’
- (4) JOHN BUY IX-a BOOK, IX-b MAGAZINE. (IX-a) BOOK EXPENSIVE.
 ‘John bought a book and a magazine. The book was expensive.’

In brief, in sign languages, loci not only maintain discourse coherence by enabling referent retrieval without repetition but also function as a disambiguating device when there are multiple, potentially competing antecedents (Ahn et al. 2019). In this sense, spatial indices play a role comparable to strong definite determiners in spoken languages.

In dynamic semantic analyses (e.g., Schlenker 2011, Zucchi 2012, cf. Lilo-Martin & Klima 1990), this idea can be captured by treating loci as indices, as given in (5) (Davidson 2022: (122)): under these analyses, IX-a is a (disguised) definite description whose value is contextually determined by assigning a referent *x* to locus *a*.²

- (5) a. $\llbracket \text{IX-a} \rrbracket^g = \iota x[x = g(a)]$
 ‘the unique individual which is equal to the referent assigned to this index *a*’
 b. $\llbracket \text{IX-a STUDENT} \rrbracket^g = \iota x[x = g(a) \wedge x \text{ is a student}]$
 ‘the unique individual which is a student and is equal to the referent assigned to this index *a*’

Under non-dynamic analyses, on the other hand, the expressions in (5a) and (5b) receive slightly different interpretations, as given in (6a, b) (Davidson 2022: (124a, b)). According to Davidson (2022: 109), $R(x, a)$ holds iff it is pragmatically appropriate to use locus *a* for *x*. She also remarks that not equating loci with indices allows us to deal with cases where multiple discourse referents are assigned to the same locus (Kuhn 2016); therefore, not treating loci as indices can be more desirable than treating them as such.

- (6) a. $\llbracket \text{IX-a} \rrbracket^g = \iota x.x \text{ is in the situation } s \text{ and } R(x, a)$
 ‘the unique individual in the situation, related via *R* to locus *a*’
 b. $\llbracket \text{IX-a STUDENT} \rrbracket^g = \iota x.x \text{ is a student and } x \text{ is in the situation } s \text{ and } R(x, a)$
 ‘the unique student in the situation related via *R* to locus *a*’

² Note that the ‘index-as-variable approach’ works most straightforwardly for anaphoric uses of IX-a. For initial occurrences, IX-a generally requires combination with a property-denoting expression such as *IX-a student*, rather than serving as a definite description on its own.

Whether one adopts a dynamic semantic approach or not, in current formal semantics literature, IX_a is treated as a definite description and locus plays a role in identifying the referent. In the next section, we introduce the way KSL marks anaphoric definites and show that while KSL also employs locus-based strategies, the role that IX plays in KSL differs from that in ASL.

3. Anaphoric Definiteness-Marking Strategies in KSL

Typologically, KSL is analogous to spoken Korean. Like Korean, it lacks grammatical articles, and it encodes definiteness through manual and spatial strategies. These include use of pointing signs, spatial loci, and composite forms that combine nominal content with pointing gestures. Such strategies parallel referential functions served by bare nouns and demonstratives (Dems) in spoken Korean, situating KSL within the broader typological group of article-less languages which include languages like Shan and Mandarin, as given in Table 1, adapted from Kim 2025.

Type of definite use	English	German (Schwarz 2009)	Shan (Moroney 2021)	Mandarin (Jenks 2018, Simpson & Wu 2022, Dayal & Jiang 2023)	Korean (Cho 2016, Ahn 2019, Kang 2021, Kim 2021a,b, Kim 2023a,b, Park 2023, Park & Kang 2024)
Typical anaphoric	<i>the</i>	Strong article	Bare/Dem	Bare/Dem	Bare/Dem

Table 1: Some cross-linguistic patterns of anaphoric definiteness marking

Similarly to spoken Korean, there are at least three types of referential expressions in KSL. The first type involves pointing signs such as IX_{HERE} and IX_{THERE}, which are used for direct deictic reference to visible entities. The second type, NP_{LOC}, associates a locus (LOC) to an individual without overt pointing, and it supports discourse anaphora in a way comparable to strong definites in spoken languages. The third type, NP-IX_{THIS}, combines a nominal with simultaneous pointing and it supports both anaphoric and emphatic reference.

Manual Marker	Gestures	Semantic Function
IX _{HERE} /IX _{THERE}	Pointing in space	Deictic demonstrative
NP _{LOC}	NP + locus assignment; no pointing	Anaphoric discourse-linked
NP-IX _{THIS}	NP + simultaneous pointing	Anaphoric and emphatic

Table 2: Referential strategies in KSL

To illustrate how each of these referential expressions in KSL is used in actual discourse, IX_{HERE} and IX_{THERE} are used to refer to visible entities that are within the signing space shared by the speaker and the addressee. These signs function as locative demonstratives and are typically used for exophoric reference, anchoring the referent directly to a location rather than to a previously introduced discourse referent:

- (7) a. IX_{THERE} BOOK BRING
‘Bring me the book that lies there.’
b. IX_{HERE} BOOK TAKE
‘Take the book that lies here.’

Unlike IX_{HERE} and IX_{THERE}, NP_{LOC} is used to refer back to a new discourse referent that has been introduced into the discourse. In minimal discourse contexts, expressions different from NP_{LOC} may be used for anaphoric purposes. This is exemplified in (8). In (8a), NP_{LOC} is used to refer back to the boy that was introduced in the preceding sentence, but using NP_{NEUT}, as in (8b), is also felicitous because there has been just one boy introduced into the discourse, so there is little room for a different interpretation. In the case of (8c), the predicate itself is locus-marked, so the NP can be omitted. In the

case of (8d), the predicate is articulated in a neutral position rather than in the NP's locus, and yet reference resolution is still possible because there is just one individual introduced into the discourse.

- (8) BOY ENTER CLASSROOM.
 a. BOY_{LOC} HAPPY. [NP_{LOC}]
 b. BOY_{NEUT} HAPPY. [NP_{NEUT}]
 c. HAPPY(NP)_{LOC}. [Predicate(NP)_{LOC}]
 d. HAPPY(NP)_{NEUT}. [Predicate(NP)_{NEUT}]
 'A boy_i entered a classroom. He_i was happy.'

Setting aside the fact that in contexts like (8) NP_{LOC} may appear to be "replaced" by other expressions, one thing we must point out here is that the referential range of NP_{LOC} extends beyond immediate clause boundaries. (9) shows that once a referent has been assigned to a locus, it can be retrieved across multiple clauses.

- (9) DEPARTMENT-STORE_{LOC-A} SHOES_{LOC-A} PRETTY,
 MONEY-SAVING_{LOC-B} SHOES_{LOC-A} BUY_{(NP)-LOC-A} WANT.
 'I saw pretty shoes_i at the store, and by saving money, I want to buy the shoes_i.'

Furthermore, (10) shows that a predicate expressed at a specific NP's locus can by itself retrieve the intended referent without an overt NP.

- (10) DEPARTMENT-STORE_{LOC-A} SHOES_{LOC-A} PRETTY,
 MONEY-SAVING_{LOC-B} BUY_{(NP)-LOC-A}.
 'I saw pretty shoes_i, and by saving money I plan to buy them_i.'

These facts lead us to see that when occurring on a predicate, NP_{LOC} can function pronominally, obviating the need for lexical repetition. This behavior provides an additional reason to treat it as a strong definite in KSL.

The contrast between NP_{LOC} and neutral-space NPs further supports classifying NP_{LOC} as a strong definite. In (11), the first clause establishes a referent via NP_{LOC-A}, but the second clause shifts to neutral space, resulting in an indefinite reading. Unlike (8), where neutral marking could still be interpreted as coreferential due to the presence of a single discourse referent in the situation, the shift in (11) indicates that the discourse is no longer anchored to a single unique referent, and hence the indefinite plural interpretation.

- (11) DEPARTMENT-STORE_{LOC-A} SHOES_{LOC-A} PRETTY, MONEY-SAVING_{LOC-B} BUY_{NEUT}.
 'I saw pretty shoes at a department store, and by saving money, I will buy any shoes.'

We should point out that spoken Korean exhibits a similar pattern: As well-established in the literature (e.g., Cho 2016, Kang 2021, Kim 2023a,b), Korean employs Dem *ku* to mark strong definiteness. So in contexts like (12), omitting *ku* yields an indefinite reading, though in some contexts (e.g., when the shoes at issue have been established as a discourse topic), the bare noun *kwutwu* can be interpreted as coreferential with the previously mentioned shoes (Jenks 2018, Ahn 2019).

- (12) onul yeypun kwutwu-lul poass-ta.
 today pretty shoes-Acc saw-Decl
 ton-ul mo-a #(ku) kwutwu-lul sa-ko.siph-ta.
 money-Acc save-Conn that shoes-Acc buy-want-Decl
 'I saw pretty shoes_i at the store. I want to buy the shoes_i by saving money.'

Given this cross-modal parallel, we conclude that NP_{LOC} performs a function that is equivalent to demonstrative-marked NPs in article-less, spoken languages.

Finally, to introduce NP-IX_{THIS}, this form indicates that the referent is not only anaphorically accessible but also evaluatively emphasized within the discourse context. To see this, consider (13). Here,

a new referent is introduced into the discourse by using a bare noun, and then re-evoked by using NP-IX_{THIS}, and this encodes mirativity and/or noteworthiness.

- (13) YESTERDAY READ BOOK. BOOK-IX_{THIS} IMPRESSIVE.
 ‘Yesterday I read a book. This book was (surprisingly) impressive.’

Further evidence for the pragmatic function of NP-IX_{THIS} comes from its compatibility with proper names. In (14), the referent Jane is already unique and discourse-accessible, yet IX_{THIS} adds an expressive meaning. Here, using NP-IX_{THIS} draws special attention to Jane, much like emphatic demonstrative constructions in English such as *THIS Jane* or *THAT Jane we talked about*. Such usage highlights the referent as noteworthy, often implying surprise or an expressive stance (cf. Lakoff 1974).

- (14) YESTERDAY MEET JANE. JANE-IX_{THIS} TALL.
 ‘Yesterday I met Jane. This Jane was (surprisingly) tall.’

Essentially the same points can be made by looking at data like (15) and (16). In (15), the noun SUN is paired with IX_{THIS}, resulting in a referential interpretation that foregrounds the specific sun under discussion. Within this discourse, SUN-IX_{THIS} conveys a meaning like ‘this very sun’ or ‘not just any sun, but that particular one.’ These properties distinguish NP-IX_{THIS} from other anaphoric forms in KSL and explain why it is appropriate to use when the speaker wishes to single out a specific, noteworthy referent.

- (15) SUN SUN-IX_{THIS} RED BIG. SUN-IX_{THIS} FEW-DAYS-AGO TODAY DIFFERNT
 ‘This sun is red and big. This sun today is different from (the one that I saw) a few days ago.’

By the same reasoning, (16), a variant of (15) which contains NP_{LOC}, is infelicitous. Here too, the content of the discourse makes it clear that the speaker is making an implicit comparison among several instantiations of the sun—such as the sun she saw a few days ago versus the sun she saw today. Therefore, using NP_{LOC-A} does not adequately capture the speaker’s intended contrast because doing so will only establish a simple anaphoric link to the previously established discourse referent.

- (16) #SUN SUN-IX_{THIS} RED BIG. SUN_{LOC-A} FEW-DAYS-AGO TODAY DIFFERNT
 Intended: ‘This sun is red and big. This sun today is different from (the one that I saw) a few days ago.’

This set of facts show that in KSL, the occurrence of IX_{THIS} on an NP encodes affectivity. Unlike demonstratives in spoken languages, however, IX_{THIS} cannot be used in a physically exophoric context. This is illustrated in (17), in contrast with (18a, b), which respectively exemplify use of a deictic demonstrative in spoken Korean and in spoken English.

- (17) *IX_{THERE/HERE} BOOK-IX_{THIS} BRING
 Intended: ‘Bring me this book that lies there/here.’

- (18) a. i chayk com ilk-e po-a.
 this book please read-Conn try-Imp.Infrml
 ‘Try reading this book.’
 b. Context: The speaker is looking at some gorilla present in the discourse context.
 That albino gorilla is very dangerous! (Simonenko 2014: 90)

To summarize, then, unlike IX_{THERE} and IX_{HERE}, NP-IX_{THIS} cannot be used situationally, in reference to a physically present entity, and yet, unlike NP_{LOC}, it transforms the referent from merely discourse-familiar to evaluatively prominent, conveying surprise or noteworthiness. Given this, we can state that KSL has at least three distinct referential expressions. In addition, we conclude that while IX is used to mark run-of-the-mill anaphoric definites in ASL, it is only used to mark pragmatically marked anaphoric definites in KSL, e.g., to encode speaker affect, mirativity, noteworthiness, contrastiveness; and in

“ordinary” anaphoric contexts, NP_{LOC} is used instead, unless even simpler forms like bare nouns and null arguments can be used. These findings are summarized in the following tables.

Manual Marker	Gestures	Examples	Semantic Function
IX _{HERE} /IX _{THERE}	Pointing in space	(7a,b)	Physical deictic reference
NP _{LOC}	NP + locus assignment (no pointing)	(8a), (9), (10)	Strong definiteness; anaphoric
NP-IX _{THIS}	NP + simultaneous pointing	(13), (14), (15), (16)	Noteworthiness, mirativity; anaphoric

Table 3: Three major strategies for definiteness marking in KSL

Sign Language	Manual Marker	Spatial Anchoring	Pointing	Semantic Function
KSL	NP _{LOC}	Integrated in NP	No	Anaphoric
	NP-IX _{THIS}	Integrated in NP	Yes	Anaphoric plus emphatic/evaluative
ASL	IX _{NEUT} IX-a	Stepwise anchoring	Yes	Anaphoric Anaphoric (contrastive)

Table 4: Spatial anchoring strategies for marking anaphoric definites in KSL and ASL

We take our findings to suggest that between NP_{LOC} and NP-IX_{THIS}, the former is the more default form in KSL (though compared to a null argument or a bare noun, it would not be). In the next section, we offer a formal semantic analysis of NP_{LOC} and NP-IX_{THIS} from which the differences between the two types of anaphoric definites fall out.

4. Formal Semantic Analysis of NP_{LOC} and NP-IX_{THIS}

Building on Kim’s (2023b) analysis of anaphoric NPs in spoken Korean, we propose that NP_{LOC} and NP-IX_{THIS} are licensed under similar conditions to demonstrative-NPs, though their correspondences with spoken Korean forms are only partial rather than exact analogues.

To begin with NP_{LOC}, we propose that it denotes a uniquely identifiable referent with a property *P* denoted by the NP, and its referent is identifiable not because of an overt determiner or pointing, but because of locus-based indexing. This strategy resembles ASL’s IX-a + NP uses, in which locus plays a role to disambiguate. However, unlike ASL’s overt index involving pointing, NP_{LOC} integrates anchoring directly into the nominal, creating a more compact referential structure.

NP_{LOC}’s referential function as a strong definite is further confirmed by its role in a two-sentence indefinite–definite narrative sequence, a template used by Kim (2023b). As schematized in (19), in a spoken language, an indefinite NP introduced in a source situation *s_s* (i.e., the situation that contains the antecedent of the anaphoric definite at issue) becomes definite in a subsequent resource situation *s_r* (i.e., the situation in which the anaphoric definite at issue occurs where its presuppositions are satisfied) when it is being referred back to by using an index.

- (19) [Text [_{*s_s*} S₁ ... indefinite NP_i ...] [_{*s_r*} S₂ ... definite NP_i ...]]

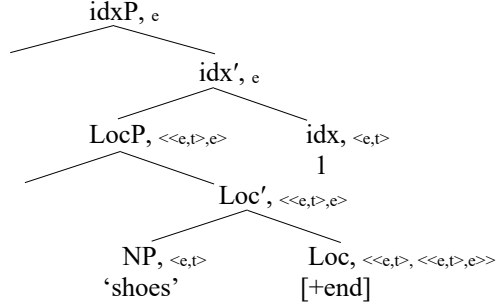
In KSL, an indefinite referent is introduced either as a bare noun or as a newly localized NP_{LOC}, and definiteness is realized through the reuse of that same locus, as schematically represented in (20).

- (20) [Text [_{*s_s*} S₁ ... NP_{LOCi} ...] [_{*s_r*} S₂ ... NP_{LOCi} ...]]

To derive the meaning of an NP_{LOC} compositionally, we assume with Kim (2023b) that anaphoric definites are index phrases (idxPs) and that determiners are locative elements and as such they head what Kim (2019) calls Locative Phrase (LocP). And we claim that the referent of an anaphoric NP_{LOC} is resolved situation-internally without comparing it with any other individual that has not been overtly introduced into the discourse in s_s . That is, it carries what Kim (2023b) calls an endophoric feature [+end].

To apply these ideas to (9), under our analysis, the second occurrence of $SHOES_{LOC-A}$ in this discourse has the syntactic structure given in (21).

(21) Syntax of the anaphoric $SHOES_{LOC-A}$ in (9)



According to this structure, the second occurrence of $SHOES$ in (9) is anchored at locus A, with the index enabling referent tracking. But what makes this expression denote an individual is the iota operator that is contributed by LOC . More specifically, we posit that LOC in KSL has the denotation that Kim (2023b) proposes for demonstratives in spoken Korean,³ namely, what is given in (22a). When we combine these ideas, we arrive at (22b) as the meaning of the anaphoric $SHOES_{LOC-A}$ in (9).

(22) Semantics of LOC and the semantics of the anaphoric $SHOES_{LOC-A}$ in (9)

- a. $\llbracket LOC \rrbracket^g = \lambda P_{\langle et \rangle} . \lambda G_{\langle et \rangle} : \exists ! x [P(x)(s_r) \ \& \ LR(x)(y)(s_s)] . \iota x [P(x)(s_r) \ \& \ LR(x)(y)(s_r) \ \& \ G(x)]$
- b. $\llbracket idxP \rrbracket^g = \llbracket LOC \rrbracket^g (\llbracket SHOES \rrbracket^g) (\llbracket 1 \rrbracket^g) = \iota x [\text{shoes}(x)(s_r) \ \& \ LR(x)(y)(s_r) \ \& \ g(x)=1]$

Given (22b), the second occurrence of $SHOES_{LOC-A}$ in (9) denotes the unique entity that stands in a locative relation (LR) to some entity in s_r , which can be the speaker or some other entity that is present in s_r . This interpretation separates the role that LOC plays from the role that a contextually given index plays (compare Lilo-Martin & Klima 1990, Schlenker 2011, Zucchi 2012, Davidson 2022). As a result, we can account for cases where plain bare nouns are used to refer to an anaphoric definite, i.e., cases like (8b), where NP_{NEUT} is used instead of NP_{LOC} .

Under the present analysis, NP_{LOC} also comes with the presupposition that the referent stands in an LR with the speaker or some other entity present in s_s ; therefore, it can be used in contexts where there is a need to disambiguate, e.g., contexts where multiple, potentially competing referents are introduced into the discourse (compare Ahn et al. 2019).

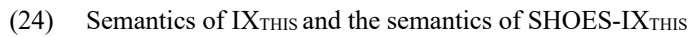
Turning now to the semantics of $NP_{IX_{THIS}}$, we argue that it differs from NP_{LOC} in two crucial respects. One is that while NP_{LOC} carries what Kim (2023b) calls [+end], $NP_{IX_{THIS}}$ carries what she calls an exophoric feature [+exo]; that is, interpreting it involves comparing its referent with a set of individuals that are not overtly introduced into the discourse in s_s .⁴ The other difference is that unlike the cases with NP_{LOC} , an individual that is referred to by using $NP_{IX_{THIS}}$ must have a salient property Q that the speaker perceives in s_s and deems as noteworthy in s_r and Q is different from the property denoted by the NP.

³ Kim (2023b) offers the following as the lexical entry for demonstratives in spoken Korean:

- (i) Semantics of demonstratives in Korean (Kim 2023b: (26))
 $\llbracket Dem \rrbracket^g = \lambda P_{\langle et \rangle} . \lambda G_{\langle et \rangle} : \exists ! x [P(x)(s_r) \ \& \ LR(x)(y)(s_s)] . \iota x [P(x)(s_r) \ \& \ LR(x)(y)(s_r) \ \& \ G(x)]$

⁴ Obviously, what Kim (2023b) calls *exophoric feature* should not be equated with *exophoric reference* in the traditional sense (e.g., Diessel 1999). Recall also that $NP_{IX_{THIS}}$ is not compatible with physically present entities, as exemplified in (17), so it does not pattern with classic exophoric, situationally used deictic expressions.

(23) Syntax of NP-IX_{THIS}



- ⁵ As noted in Kim 2019, when functioning as affective markers, demonstratives in spoken Korean can also be obligatory if the anaphoric definite at hand comes with a noteworthy property that is denoted by an attributive adjective. We defer discussing such cases in comparison with data containing NP-IX_{THIS} to another occasion.

- (26) ecey ceyin-ul manna-ss-e.
yesterday Jane-Acc meet-Pst-Decl.Infrml
‘Yesterday I met a kid named Jane.’
- a. */#(i) ceyin-i-la-nun ay khi-ka emcheng khu-te-la.
this Jane-Cop-known.as-Rel kid height-Nom very big-Rtro-Decl.Infrml
Intended: ‘This Jane was (surprisingly) really tall.’
- b. *i ceyin khi-ka emcheng khu-te-la.
this Jane height-Nom very big-Rtro-Decl.Infrml
Intended: ‘This Jane was (surprisingly) really tall.’
- (27) cwungdong-ey phyenghwa-ka iss-ulkes kat-a.
middle.east-Loc peace-Nom exist-be.likely seem-Decl.Infrml
‘It seems that there will be peace in the middle east.’
- */#(i) Henry Kissinger-la-nun salam cham
this Henry Kissinger-Cop-known.as-Rel person truly
mwulken-i-ya!
extraordinary-Cop-Excl.Infrml
Intended: ‘This Henry Kissinger really is something!’

In sum, then, both NP_{LOC} and NP-IX_{THIS} are locus-based morphosyntactic devices that are used for encoding anaphoric definiteness, and they have similar internal syntax, but between the two, NP-IX_{THIS} is more marked because it comes with enriched pragmatic meaning and this is reflected in its lexical entry. More specifically, while NP_{LOC} has the semantics of a strong anaphoric definite that comes with a descriptive content, NP-IX_{THIS} conventionally implicates that the referent of the definite has some property *Q* that is known to the speaker but may not to the addressee and it is being implicitly compared with individuals that are not overtly introduced into the discourse.

5. Conclusions

This paper has examined how KSL encodes anaphoric definiteness, focusing on NP_{LOC} and NP-IX_{THIS}. We have shown that both KSL and ASL employ locus-based strategies to mark anaphoric definites but unlike ASL, KSL does not employ IX to mark run-of-the-mill anaphoric definites; instead, it uses IX to encode what Kim (2023b) calls [+exo], and in the case of NP-IX_{THIS}, the combination of IX and THIS encodes speaker affect. We have also shown that KSL is similar to Korean in the sense that it utilizes a locative element to mark strong definites. Our findings show that demonstratives can perform more than one function in spoken languages, one is to encode anaphoric definiteness, and the other is to encode pragmatically enriched meaning. Our findings also implicate that, in any given language, the default anaphoric definite marker involves what Kim (2023b) calls [+end] and the non-default marker involves what she calls [+exo], and this accounts for the division of labor between *the* and *that* in English, as well as the difference between anaphoric bare nouns and anaphoric demonstrative-NPs in article-less languages like Korean and Mandarin. Finally, our analysis shows that separating indices from loci yields positive results for capturing the distribution and interpretation of anaphoric bare nouns and anaphoric non-bare nouns in KSL. Therefore, the present analysis may carry over to ASL. However, verifying this must be left for future research. It also remains to be seen whether what we have proposed for NP-IX_{THIS} carries over to all affectively used demonstratives in human language.

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